



MONTHLY UPDATE

Cote d'Ivoire: monthly update, July 2026

Edition of 2026-08-18 · 53 systems and instruments tracked, 10 of them not held

Developments recorded from artefacts published between 2026-07-01 and 2026-08-17 — July 2026 carried forward to the date of issue, so the report holds the nightly catch to the day it was cut. Sections follow the status report.

Summary of the month

July brought the trust layer and the market layer within eight days of each other. The cyber agency [commissioned the national public key infrastructure](#), announced on 23 July, and a low-orbit satellite operator [went on sale by 17 July](#) on a twelve-month provisional licence. The data-protection compliance platform went live on 2 July, all 39 first-instance tribunals were connected on 29 June, and the United States announced [formal authorisation of a US\\$170m data-centre and border-surveillance package](#) on 16 July.

Infrastructure

Connectivity

A low-orbit satellite operator [went live by 17 July](#) at XOF 28,746 a month for residential service, with hardware from XOF 148,148, on a twelve-month provisional licence reviewable on service quality. On 31 July the minister said regional satellite capacity would be routed through the universal-service bodies, with a working session on terms due the following week; no terms, tariff or timetable was stated. No 5G launch occurred against the announced July 2026 date. Ministry figures given on 13 July put telecommunications penetration above 130% of population and [about 38,000 km of optical fibre](#).

On protecting what is already laid, an operator and its vendor [completed a proof of concept in Abidjan that detects vibrations around fibre ducts and classifies them to flag third-party excavation before a cut happens](#), on trials run since 2025. The account is vendor-issued and states no commercial deployment, coverage or date.

Data Storage

The national data centre was [formally authorised at US\\$170m of United States export-credit financing, its scope now a sovereign data centre, a government digitisation platform and a smart-border surveillance system](#) — up from the US\$66m approved in August 2025, with no site, capacity or completion date stated. The operating commercial facility at Grand-Bassam is unchanged at a design capacity of about 400 racks and 1.5 MW, while its [group committed capital rose to US\\$380m and contracted power across a six-country footprint ran six times higher in the first half of 2026 than a year earlier](#) — group figures, not Ivorian ones.

Cybersecurity

The cyber agency [commissioned the national public key infrastructure](#) on an announcement dated 23 July 2026, on the legal basis of the 2013 electronic-transactions law and its 2014 and 2016 decrees. It is the trust anchor for every certification authority operating on Ivorian territory; the agency's own notice is not held, so the technical commissioning date is unestablished.

Digital public infrastructure

Data Exchange

The minister told an information-systems seminar on 21 and 22 July that the first services onto the interoperability platform [had been chosen largely by volunteering rather than against user priorities](#), against targets of 100 services online by end-2026 and 700 within three years. No count of services in production has been published. Fourteen migration bodies met on 30 July to [co-design a single collection and profiling tool for returning migrants](#) and a roadmap for transferring their data into one directorate; no legal basis, data-protection safeguard or timetable for pooling personal data across fourteen bodies is stated.

Digital Identity and CRVS

The identification office's director general [put national identification number holders at roughly 11 million](#) on 30 July and named historic duplicate identities inside the register — the disclosure, not the register, is what is new. The office trained sub-prefects on civil registration on 30 and 31 July, after registrars earlier that week.

Digital Payments and Fintech

A private schools federation signed a convention on 21 July putting fee collection onto mobile money in a 200-school pilot from August. The flat FCFA 100 agency fee levied on every mobile-money counter transaction since November 2025 was [documented on 24 July](#) as authorised by no operator tariff and no regulator, regressive by construction on small transfers.

Registries (population, land, address, etc.)

Civil-registry software is [installed with hardware in every municipal and sub-prefecture civil-status centre for digital recording of births, marriages and deaths, financed by the European Union](#). Supervision is assigned to sub-prefects rather than to registrars, and the reform is framed as anti-fraud rather than as access.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

All 39 first-instance tribunals were [connected to the justice platform on 29 June 2026](#), completing an arc that began with a two-court pilot in January 2025; nationality certificates and criminal-record extracts are now issued digitally nationwide. The account describes this as completing phase one, with no phase-two scope or date. The regulator's compliance platform [went live on 2 July 2026](#), slipping from a 25 June date, replacing about a hundred physical files a month with online submission, real-time tracking and traceability for conformity, processing authorisations and video-surveillance authorisations. It was built over two years and piloted by the identification office and the treasury.

Governance and regulation

Legislation and regulation

The cyber-security agency is [operating a national security operations centre, a public-administration security-officer network, the national public key infrastructure and auditor certification against the state reference framework](#), resting on the 2013 electronic transactions law whose 2014 and 2016 implementing decrees are the stated legal basis for that infrastructure — the only Ivorian digital statute the base can name implementing decrees for. Against that, [no Ivorian artificial-intelligence statute is published](#): governance runs entirely through non-binding strategy instruments, with the draft cybersecurity strategy the only binding-track vehicle extending state scope to it.

Strategies, plans and policies

The draft cyber-security strategy for 2026 to 2030 was [put to stakeholder review on 23 July](#) and awaits the Council of Ministers; the 2021 to 2025 text remains the instrument formally in force. The draft extends scope to artificial intelligence, emerging technologies and cloud.

The universal-service agency published its own five-year plan on 11 August. It [rests on four pillars — universal connectivity, digital services and financial inclusion, digital usage and literacy, and operational excellence — across ten projects, four of them funded at FCFA 60.144bn through the national development plan and six from the agency's own funds](#). The stated targets are 300 newly connected localities, smartphone penetration of 80% by 2028 against 40% now, and more than 15,000 km of new fibre by 2028, against a starting point at which 70% of rural households have no internet access. No adoption instrument is published; the plan is the agency's own.

Standards

On 29 July the agency [set a target of 1,200 certified cyber-security specialists in three years](#), with 88 auditors certified that day.

Data protection

The mobile-money agents' union [wrote to the regulator on 24 July](#) with four questions on whether kiosk agents may demand, photograph or retain customer identity documents, after four operators required retention. No regulator response is on file.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

A consumer federation [launched a complaints platform on 30 July](#) charging FCFA 150 per report, with eight stages from filing through mediation to published reports.

Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

AI

Six francophone West African states adopted common artificial-intelligence governance guidelines announced on 6 July, non-binding and complementary to national strategies, submitted as a written contribution to a United Nations dialogue. The minister addressed that dialogue in Geneva on 6 and 7 July and proposed a regional African school of artificial intelligence.

ICT Industry

An electric ride-hailing fleet took delivery of 100 vehicles on 18 July.

Innovation ecosystem

The ministry [launched two accelerator cohorts and a state procurement platform on 29 July](#), fifteen startups and fifteen digital small firms each accompanied for 24 months, applications closing 13 September, against a target of FCFA 5 to 10bn mobilised from banks, funds and donors.

US / hyperscaler activities

The United States announced on 16 July that a contractor had received [formal Ivorian authorisation for a US\\$170m export-credit-financed project](#) covering a sovereign national data centre, a government digitisation platform and a smart-border surveillance system, up from US\$66m approved in August 2025. The announcement was made by the United States rather than by any Ivorian instrument.

Inclusion and capacity

Access to services

A guarantee arrangement was the month's only committed money in this section. Two conventions signed on 23 July mobilise [up to FCFA 17bn across two windows](#) for small and medium enterprises, with stated attention to women's entrepreneurship; it is an envelope rather than a committed sum.

Literacy

The national education digitalisation project stands at [six of eight components complete with the technical and financial agreement still unsigned](#). No cost, financier or component list is published: the project is described only by its stage count.

Training and skills

The civil-service digital-skills programme [closed its thirteenth edition on 29 July](#), training 192 officials from about thirty public bodies over 40 days, against a cumulative claim of more than 37,500 civil servants funded from the ministry's own budget line.

Outside the service, a German-funded accelerator closed a three-month cohort on 4 August, [closing with 51 artificial-intelligence projects across finance, health, law, education and cybersecurity](#). The project count is the only measure published: participant numbers, cost and what becomes of the projects after the demonstration day are not stated, and a project shown at one is not a deployed system.

Research institutions

The cyber agency and a technology school validated curricula for two cyber-security master's degrees on 28 July, with enrolment stated for the September 2026 academic year and no intake size or funding published.

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